Uda City Forestry Cooperative (宇陀市森林組合) — Kumiai Dayori No. 27 (July 2026)

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Source: `/home/rob/Documents/Mitsue/Mitsue Village Project AI data center/research/uda_city/scan-2611061516/scan-001.pdf` (11 pages, scanned 2026-11-06; cover says "令和8年7月発行", No.27 — the user called it the "21st" letter; the 21st is the *general assembly*, 第21回通常総代会). **Raw OCR (JP):** `/home/rob/Documents/Mitsue/Mitsue Village Project AI data center/research/uda_city/scan-2611061516/scan-001_ocr_raw.json` (PaddleOCR GPU, `lang=japan`). **Contact (from letterhead):** 宇陀市森林組合, 奈良県宇陀市榛原檜牧1026, Tel 0745-82-1409, Fax 0745-82-7543, http://www.uda-shinrin.com, uda-sin@cotton.ocn.ne.jp **OCR caveat:** narrative text is reliable; balance-sheet (p.4) and plan table (p.7) are garbled in places — figures below are only those read unambiguously. Verify against the paper before quoting externally.

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p.1 Cover — Operating policy (運営の基本方針)

Issued as combined annual report + annual plan. Policy: forestry/timber industry remains in a tough situation (timber price and demand swings, persistently high material costs, aging workforce/lack of successors, fuel/material price risk from international affairs). The coop will: maintain proper forest management and use of forest resources, **centre work on thinning (間伐)**, ensure work safety, improve efficiency and cut costs, keep sound finances, handle only legally-verified timber, cooperate with agencies, and maintain forests' multiple functions.

- Summer holiday: 8/2–8/6 (OCR shows weekdays "水～日" which don't match 2026 — check).
- Note: anyone applying for thinning subsidy needs the separate sheet 「補助金を申請するにあたって」.

p.2 21st Ordinary General Assembly (第21回通常総代会)

- Held **26 June 2026, 13:30–15:00**, 市農林会館 large hall, Haibara-Shimoiaoshi.
- Chair of the coop (組合長): **大門** (Daimon); vice-chair **松尾** (Matsuo) closed the meeting.
- Guests (祝辞): **Uda Mayor 金剛一智**, Uda Council chair 廣澤孝英, Nara East Agriculture & Forestry Office head 藤田浩之. Introduced: council committee chair 南浦寿雄, Uda 農林商工部長 上西剛司, Nara 森と人の共生推進課 head 荒木宏之, Uda 農林課長 上林孝司, 課長補佐 岡村邦彦, Nara 主査 坂口健介, Uda 主査 田井戸逸平.
- Quorum: 43 in person + 90 written votes + 11 proxies = **144 of 192 delegates (75%)**. Chair elected: 薄木孝雄 (Utano).
- All agenda items approved as proposed:
  1. FY2025 business report & financials. 2. FY2026 business plan.
  2. **Levy (賦課金) ¥4.1M**, collected Jul–Aug, equal share + per-area; area unit price unified at **¥100**.
  3. Director pay ≤ ¥5.46M/yr total; auditors ≤ ¥80k/yr.
  4. **Borrowing ceiling ¥300M.** 6. Max loan per member ¥15M.
  5. Handling fees (see p.9). 8. Deposit banks: Norinchukin, Japan Post Bank, Nara JA, Nanto Bank, Yamato Shinkin.
  - Riders: board may amend plan mid-year; minor corrections delegated to board.

p.3 FY2025 business report (1 Apr 2025 – 31 Mar 2026)

Macro: wage growth >5% two years running but inflation outpaces wages, US tariffs/weak yen, Takaichi government (Oct 2025) stimulus package. Coop by department:

- **Guidance:** levy collection rate **95%**; newsletter, individual forest consultations; thinning seminar, chainsaw-maintenance seminar, Utano elementary forestry class, factory tour for Ichijo High School attached junior high; survey of members.
- **Sales:** log/purchased-goods sales **102%** of plan; promoting Uda/Nara timber; offcut (端材) sales.
- **Processing: 144%** of plan; civil-engineering materials and boards strong; growing non-housing demand; Haibara Kodomo-en (nursery) used Uda timber.
- **Forest works:** above plan, profitable; **high-place special felling** and felling/extraction jobs completed; **施業放置林 (neglected forest) and mixed-forest guidance projects**. Utilization lower than last year (subsidy handling, surveying, firewood). Purchasing above plan. Member discount coupons used: 43 people, ¥816,084.
- **Admin:** costs 137% of prior year (salary scale revision, 1 new hire).
- **Non-operating:** one vehicle/machine sold at a gain.
- Overall: **above plan, profit (黒字)**.

p.4 FY2025 financial statements (as of 31 Mar 2026; yen)

Item	Amount
Total assets	162,971,737
Current assets	125,509,490
Fixed assets	~37,462,247
Short-term borrowing	66,000,000
Total liabilities	98,072,291
Members' capital (出資金)	49,455,400
Net assets	64,899,446
Operating revenue (事業収益)	150,556,355
Gross operating profit (事業総利益)	63,493,718
Personnel costs	36,259,858
Ordinary profit (経常利益)	12,555,851
Pre-tax profit	12,902,589
Surplus for the year	**11,446,370**
Prior-year carry-forward loss	1,899,378
Distribution: legal reserve 2.67M; voluntary reserve 7.0M; carry to next 3,675,748	

p.5–6 FY2026 business plan (令和8年度 事業計画書)

Policy text same as p.1. Departments:

- **Guidance:** newsletter; silviculture proposals; Forest Environment Transfer Tax and specific-thinning promotion plan; Nara/certified/legal timber; thinning and chainsaw seminars; **wildlife damage prevention**; **forestry successor training**; lobbying for forestry budgets.
- **Sales:** promote prefectural timber; promote handling of thinning wood. **Processing:** building & civil materials, woodwork (more orders from carpenters/builders).

- **Forest works:** tending (planting, weeding, pruning, thinning); extraction; neglected-forest thinning; mixed-forest works; work-road construction/repair; public works; high-place/hazard-tree felling. **Utilization:** survey/surveying, subsidy handling, **Green Employment (緑の雇用)**, damage surveys, firewood, forest insurance. Welfare (労災 admin). **Purchasing:** forestry/living goods, **member-only 20%-off coupon**. Finance: forestry-industry improvement loans, JFC loans.

p.7 FY2026 profit & handling plan (thousand yen; table partly garbled)

- Revenue **135,765**; expenses 97,140; gross profit **38,625**; personnel 24,000; business profit 1,837; ordinary profit **2,737**; tax 1,482; **net surplus 1,255**.
- Guidance dept revenue 7,872 (levy 4,100, Uda City subsidy 3,772).
- Sales 7,400 revenue; **Processing 41,000** sales;
- **Forest works contract plan = 71,000**: neglected-forest projects **16,000 (30.0 ha)**; mixed-forest guidance **14,000 (2.0 ha)**; **high-place special felling 10,000 (20 jobs)**; wildlife fence + planting 27,000 (2); felling/extraction 2,000 (5); prefectural forest thinning 2,000.
- Other: survey income 650 (30 jobs), Green Employment 1,500, subsidy-handling fees 1,800, firewood ~1,100, purchasing 1,650.
- Plan is **much more conservative than FY2025** (surplus ¥1.3M vs ¥11.4M).

p.8 (duplicate of p.6 scan)

p.9 Members, capital, fees

- Members: start of year 1,164 (正 1,160 + 準 **4** associate) → end **1,145 (正 1,141 + 準 4)**; shares 494,554 (¥49,455,400). Standard capital: **240 shares = ¥24,000 per ha**.
- Officers: 11 directors (1 full-time), 2 auditors = 13; **6 staff**.
- Handling fees (excl. tax; **non-members pay double**): subsidy handling ≤10% of subsidy; forest certificate ¥6,000 per lot (+¥500 each additional); guided site visit ¥18,000 half-day / ¥35,000 day; commissioned work ≤15% of project cost; loan rate cap 11%/yr; area survey ¥3,000 per case (+¥1,000 per tan above 2 tan); road survey ¥7,500 to 100 m, +¥3,000 per 50 m; survey/investigation ≤15% of direct cost; workers'-comp admin ¥2,000 + 12% of premium; retirement-fund admin ¥3,000/person/yr; JFC loan fee 0.5% of balance.

p.10 Notices to members

- Keep member/forest registers updated (ownership changes, inheritance, area changes). Levy is based on official registered area (山林・原野); **forest not enrolled is treated as non-member use**.
- Subsidies need a prior plan and government approval; subsidy procedure reviewed since FY2021.
- **Felling notification changes (from FY2025):** under the specific-thinning promotion plan a 適合通知書 (conformity notice) can be issued via application instead of 伐採届; needed even to sell the timber; notify **≥2 months before felling**. **Clear-cut requires replanting** (exceptions under forest management plans).
- **Forest Management Plan (森林経営計画):** replaces old plan; requires ≥30 ha etc.; subsidy/tax benefits.
- Land-acquisition notification (since Apr 2012) required after purchase/inheritance/gift, even for small areas.
- **Inheritance registration mandatory since 1 Apr 2024:** within 3 years (fine ≤¥100,000); address/name changes within 2 years (fine ≤¥50,000); applies to past inheritances; contact Nara Legal Affairs Bureau.

p.11 Subsidy overview (as of June 2025)

- Needs forest management plan or specific-thinning plan; thinning plans due **end of August** of application year; before/during/after photos from same spot.
- Forest Resource Management 1st class: ≥100 ha consolidated, 15 ha/750 m extraction thinning/yr; 2nd class: from 0.1 ha. Planting: ≥2,000 sugi/hinoki or 1,000 broadleaf per ha. Under-planting 1,000 / 500. Weeding ages 1–5. Thinning: cut ≥20% (volume ≤35%), **≥10 m³/ha extracted with sales slip**, ages 11–80 sugi / 90 hinoki. Work roads with planting/extraction.
- 美しい森林づくり交付金 (non-qualifying work). **施業放置林整備事業**: city–owner agreement, strong thinning, sugi/hinoki ≤60 yrs.
- Thinning seminars planned (date TBD; sign up with the coop).
- **"Anyone shipping woody-biomass power chip wood via the coop must contact the coop."**
- Services: old/miscellaneous tree felling, hazard-tree felling, forest work/management, work roads; firewood sales.

Relevance to Mitsue project (notes)

- Peer benchmark: a ~1,145-member coop with 6 staff, ¥150M revenue, thin plan margin (¥1.3M); biggest lines = neglected-forest thinning (¥16M/30 ha), mixed forest, high-place felling.
- Biomass hook: p.11 confirms the coop already brokers biomass **power chip** shipments — ask who the buyer is and the price.
- Associate (準) members are only 4 — relevant to Rob's associate-membership application; non-member fees are doubled.
- Names to add/check in people table: 大門 (組合長), 松尾 (副組合長); Mayor 金剛一智; officials above.
- Sugi/hinoki-focused; no mention of kiri (paulownia).